Saturday 6th July, 6.00pm

Sleeper (10'00")

Julian Knowles

Aural navigations, slo-core laptop electronics, deep dsp, time lapse field recordings - a seething mass of unfolding tones, drones and cinematic audiospaces... *Sleeper* represents an ongoing engagement with the laptop as musical instrument. Processed field recordings and pure synthesised audio collide and interweave to form complex sonic narratives. One of my principal compositional aims is to uncover the inherent musicality in found and captured audio, distilling materials from its raw complex state via subtractive, or filtering processes, to uncover hidden harmonic structures and pitch sets. Further processes are undertaken whereby these distilled forms of captured audio come into contact with synthesised audio and ambiguous sonic relationships are explored. In a sense I am inviting the listener to listen 'beneath the surface' of the sound as well as inviting the listener to disassociate sounds from their sources in order to liberate these materials in the musical realm. The work presented in this concert is an excerpt from the much larger 45'00" work.

Julian Knowles is a composer/performer working with computers, sound synthesis, field recording and digital audio processing. His work spans studio and live performance, composition, and sound design for film, exploring the inherent (im)possibilities of various audio manoeuvres and uncovers the musicality of unlikely sound sources. He synthesises elements from an eclectic range of sonic practices such as acousmatic music, film sound, location recording, pop music production techniques, surround sound and audio dsp. As a solo performer, Julian has toured the UK, USA, Latin America and Korea to critical acclaim and is also a member of the group Social Interiors (Extreme Records). He is currently a Senior Lecturer and Electronic Arts/Music Technology Co-ordinator at the University of Western Sydney.

not even the rain (9'34")

Benjamin Thigpen

nothing which we are to perceive in this world equals
the power of your intense fragility: whose texture
compels me with the colour of its countries,
rendering death and forever with each breathing
(i do not know what it is about you that closes
and opens; only something in me understands
the voice of your eyes is deeper than all roses)
nobody, not even the rain, has such small hands

– e. e. cummings

When I was maybe 12 or 13 years old, I read a short story about a man who was to be hanged. He mounted the scaffold; the noose was placed around his neck; the flooring dropped out from under him, and ... the rope broke. His wife ran up and hugged him. He was pardoned by the governor. And he went off to lead a long, rich, happy life, prospering and fathering a family. He lived to a very old age, and on his deathbed he was surrounded by family and friends.... Then the noose broke his neck and he died.

I have since been fascinated with this sort of temporal pocket, in which we can have years of experience in a fraction of a second. The temporality of *not even the rain* is based on this model.

All the sound events of the piece evolve out of two groups of percussive attacks – one at the very beginning, the other about a third of the way through. As the resonance of the initial attack-group slowly fades away, the music sinks into it, so to speak, tracing something like a descent into its tiniest elements – which become progressively more and more animated, shifting and evolving in sometimes unpredictable ways. The two halves of the piece (following the two attack-groups) sketch similar gestures – descending through layers of soundspace – the second moving more quickly, speaking more emphatically, falling more drastically. And arriving, in the final section of the piece, at something like the "heart of mystery."

What it's about. Perceiving the endless energy concealed within the most inert objects. Piercing through the world-as-surface and plunging through various mysterious layers. Falling. Exploring this infinite, ungraspable energy.

not even the rain is based entirely on "the speaking of the object" – and objects speak in unknown languages. The experience of composing it was not one of imposing my will upon the sounds to make them express something I feel, but rather one of getting out of the way. Of allowing something to come into being through me. Of being surpassed.

All the sounds were generated by sound processing programs I wrote in Max/MSP. The music was composed and spatialized in 8 channels using Pro Tools at the studio Musiques et Recherches [Ohain, Belgium]. In 2002, I revised the piece and produced a stereo version at the Groupe de Recherches Musicales [Paris].

Benjamin Thigpen studied music (saxophone, flute, guitar, oboe), literature and philosophy. Degrees: B.A. in English Literature (Oberlin College, 1982); M.A. in Comparative Literature (UCLA, 1990); D.E.A. in Aesthetics, Technologies and Artistic Creations (University of Paris VIII, 1998). In between: voyages; jobs in fishing boats, taxis, libraries, restaurants and bars. One day in Chicago (1985): first electroacoustic experiments with three cassette recorders. After: studies in recording techniques, sound synthesis, composition, aesthetics, electroacoustics, and computer music (Elaine Barkin, Samuel Weber, Christian Eloy, Jacques Lejeune, Curtis Roads, Julio Estrada, Horacio Vaggione).

Currently teaching sound processing and real time systems (Max/MSP) at Ircam [Paris].

Electroacoustic compositions performed in concert and on the radio in Europe, North and South America, Australia and New Zealand, as well as on the web. dust was awarded a mention in the preselection of the competition Prix Noroit 1997, as well as in the competition Musica Nova 1998. step, under was awarded a mention in the competition Métamorphoses 2000. h is available on the CD Acousmatica I (distributed by Metamkine); an excerpt of step, under is on the CD Présence II (distributed by Diffusion i Média).

Water Baby (7'00")

Paul Todd - clarinet

Brigid Burke - live electronics, bass clarinet

Water Baby is inspired by my long term fascination with water and all its sonic possibilities. The journey began in June last year when I performed an improvisation at the Make It Up Club using a saucepan of water with clarinet and extension pipe. The sounds I discovered are the basis for the clarinet part. The pre-recorded material was developed with everyday water sounds such as filling up the sink and pulling out the plug, blowing bubbles, splashing in the rain, and water gushing through a down-pipe. The live clarinet, bass clarinet and water is manipulated live with a variety of reverbs, loops and pitch shifters. It is an improvised theatrical soundscape.

Paul Todd was born in Adelaide in 1979. His music education began at age nine when he began piano lessons. At age thirteen he started clarinet lessons and fell in love with the instrument. Paul is a graduate of the Elder Conservatorium of Music, Adelaide, where he was principal clarinettist of the Orchestra, Wind Ensemble and the Elder New Music Ensemble. He has appeared with the Adelaide Symphony Orchestra and the Adelaide Philharmonia Orchestra and won many awards including the inaugural Musicorp Award for excellence in Music Performance in 2001 and first prize in the wind, brass, percussion concerto section of the Adelaide Eisteddfod, also in 2001. His inspiration to compose music theatre is a result of collaborations with German based performance artist, Jo Dudley and British composer, Peter Maxwell-Davies. Other works include Mr Bateman and his Modern Driving Machine, which was premiered by Halogen Saxophone Quartet at the Postgraduate Symposium for Music in Canberra in September 2001. In 2002 Paul graduated from honours at Monash University, School of Music - Conservatorium where he is currently undergoing a Master of Arts (Music Performance). He is also a clarinettist in re-sound contemporary music and baritone saxophonist in Halogen Saxophone Quartet.

Birdspeaker Piece #3 (3'56")

Peter Mcilwain

The Birdspeaker Pieces are a series of works that are generated by the SNet software. This software employs a behavioural-based model of biological neural nets. It is designed to generate spatio-temporal patterns by allocating audio events to 16 independent audio channels (this can be reduced to 8 or 4 channels if necessary). The software was developed by Peter Mcilwain who is Lecturer in Composition at the School of Music – Conservatorium at Monash University.

Peter is a composer specialising in computer and electro acoustic music but has a wide range of musical and artistic interests. These include writing works for traditional ensembles, film and music theatre as well as computer music and installation art. Recent projects have included the development of software which generates and distributes music in multi-speaker sound systems using a connectionist nodal network approach as well as the development of a flocking algorithm which generates melodies in response to movements by a performer using an ultrasonic sensor. He is

Lecturer in Composition and Music Technology in the School of Music - Conservatorium at Monash University where he is also a member of Dome the contemporary gamelan ensemble based at the University.

The Mossy Slopes of Mt. Meru (15'00")

Warren Burt

"The Mossy Slopes of Mt. Meru" (2002) is a piece made with scales developed from additive number series that are foun d by adding up the diagonals of Pingala`s Meru Prastara, known in the West as Pascal`s Triangle. Following suggestions by Ervin Wilson, I developed a family of 30 scales from the first 5 number series, and play them, for this performance, with sine waves. These sine waves carve up the space they are played in into various spatial configurations which can easily be heard by moving one`s head slightly as one listens. Thus, tuning, timbre, and sound-space architecture become unified into a single musical gesture. I certainly don't expect the listener to be interested in following, or able to follow all the arithmetical things I did to make this piece. But I made the piece to find SOUNDS, and it is these sound that I now wish to share with whoever is interested in experiencing them.

Warren Burt has just returned from 5 months in the USA where he taught at the University of Illinois, and was also composer in residence at ArtScienceLab, Santa Fe, New Mexico, and the Pauline Oliveros Foundation, Kingston, NY. He is now resuming his active freelance life, and is available for weddings, parties, and new music jamborees everywhere.

Lands Collide (9'00")

Brigid Burke

The concept of the composition is to make the sounds and visuals grow in and out of each other with depth and constant movement with combinations of definition and confusion but as a whole to create unity.

Another means to create this unity was the transformation of the acoustic tom toms, drums, clarinet key clicks and voice articulations performed by composer and Wendy Couch, percussion into lyrically thick percussive sounds overlapping themselves to form complex rhythms. These short percussive rhythmic patterns are overlaid and textured into ten channels both live and prerecorded.

Throughout Lands Collide old maps and landscape that has been untainted by man, Javanese flutes and gongs, organic drawings also largely influenced me. The sounds and visuals are unique, like the wind, full of rich sonorities just waiting to be transformed or left alone. The aim was also to try and convey moments, portraying a simplistic, guttural, earthy yet sophisticated sound field and landscape as one can feel when in nature and experiencing non-western music. This work explores various frequency changes with these sound and visual worlds through extreme contraction, expansion, panning and pitch modification. Lands Collide can also be described as an exploration of sounds at different dynamic and room placements and been embedded into different scenes by means of subtle dynamic curves both visually and aurally.

Brigid is a composer, clarinet soloist, visual artist, and educator. She has performed extensively in solo and chamber recitals, both nationally and internationally. Performances of her compositions include in 2002 ***Cybersonica International Festival of Digital Music and Sound*** *at The ICA, London,* ***MAXIS 2002*** *Festival / Symposium of Audio & Art in England,* ***art@radio*** *on the River Hull Hull Time Based Arts, Hull, England,* ***Seoul International Computer Music Festival 2001,*** *and* ***Medi@terra*** ***Festival micromuseum International Digital Audio &Video Festival****, Bulgaria, Slovenia and Frankfurt. Also solo and chamber performances at Federation Music Week Contemporary Music of Australia and the Asia Pacific, St. James the Great, Grainger Museum, Melba Conservatorium and Kaliede Theatre RMIT.*

Highlights of previous years include Sonic Residues2 Festival, PATO Adelaide funded by the Australia Council Performing Arts Board, BEAT International Gamelan Festival, Experimenta, Victorian Arts Centre Live and Melbourne International Festivals.

Brigid has also received twelve art awards and exhibited through out Japan in the ***Japanese International Hand Printed & Shhin Kohanga*** *competition from 1989-2002.*

As a freelance performer/composer Brigid is broadcast on ABC FM including local & overseas radio and is currently working on a commission from the ***Australian Broadcasting Commission*** *Listening Room to be broadcast late in 2002. Her most recent CD recordings are* ***INTERSECT, TRI DUO, BURKE & WILMOT and Electronic Compositions 1997-2001*** *which have been reviewed and broadcast internationally****.*** *The Performing Arts Board of the Australia Council, ANAT, South Australian Govt., Community Arts Centers and Universities have also supported*

Wendy Couch : Percussionist- Following graduation from Melbourne University and the V.C.A. Wendy was awarded a Churchill Fellowship to study in California. There she completed an M.A.in Percussion Performance at San Jose State University, studying withAnthony.J.Cirone.

She has presented solo recitals and concertos in Australia and the U.S.A. As a freelance musician she has performed frequently with the Melbourne Symphony, Australian Pops Orchestra, Canto Coro and the Australian Boys Choir. During the last 12 years she has played for many operas and ballets with the State Orchestra of Victoria. Theatre productions include 'Cho Cho San' and 'Sabat Jesus' (Playbox), 'Stroke'(Chamber Made Opera),'Les Miserables', 'Phantom of the Opera', 'The King and I'and 'Theatro'(1998 Melbourne International Festival).

Wendy has a vast repertoire of Chamber Music and Contemporary Percussion works and frequently performs with clarinettist Brigid Burke. She also has extensive teaching experience at both Tertiary and Secondary level. She is currently teaching Percussion at Camberwell Grammar, Mac.Robertson Girls' High School and Canterbury Girls' Secondary College. She has played the organ at the Melbourne Welsh Church for the last 12 years and is an A.M.E.B. Examiner.